Frontend Developer Workflows, Design Tools, and Design-to-Code Automation

6 responses

Publish analytics

Developer Profile & Roles

What best describes your primary role?

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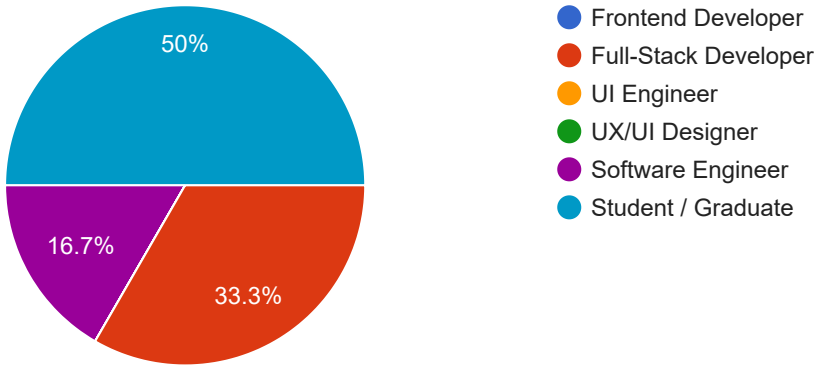

Years of professional development experience

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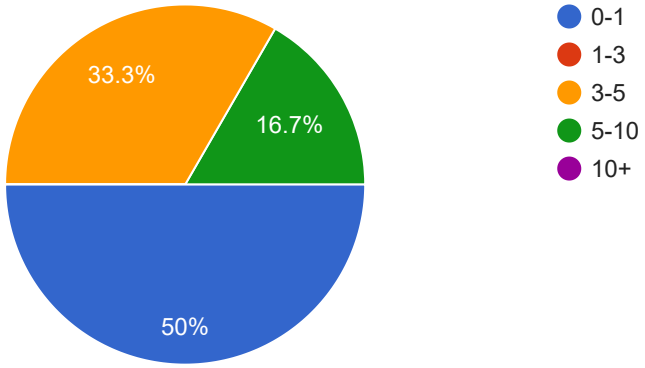

Industry you primarily work in (e.g Web development, startups, agency, e-commerce)

5 responses

Student

Retail (Kitchen & Home Retail) - in-house software team

Student

Im a student

Technology solutions

Team size you usually work in

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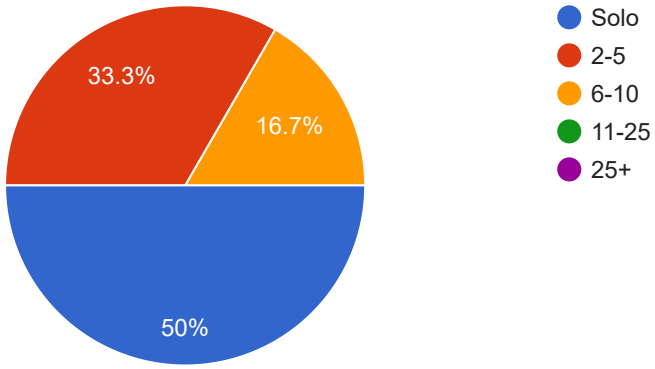

Level of involvement in UI decisions

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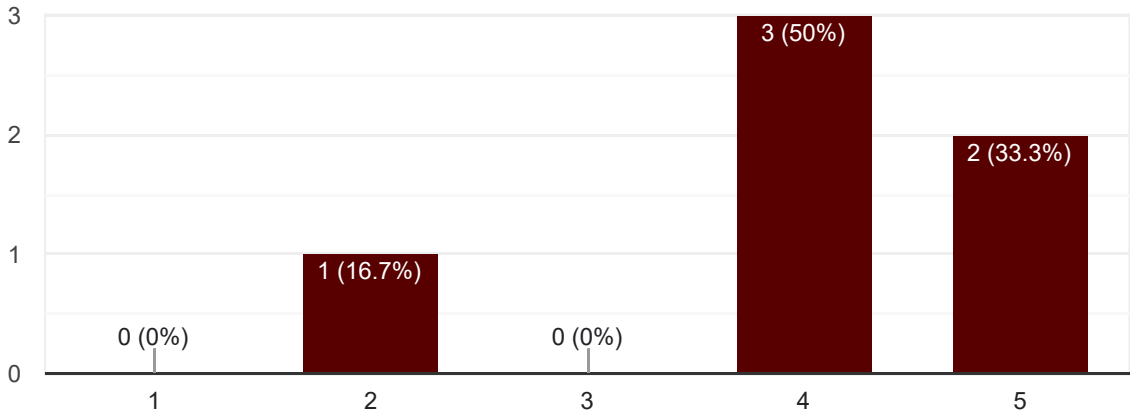

How frequently do you build UI components from scratch?

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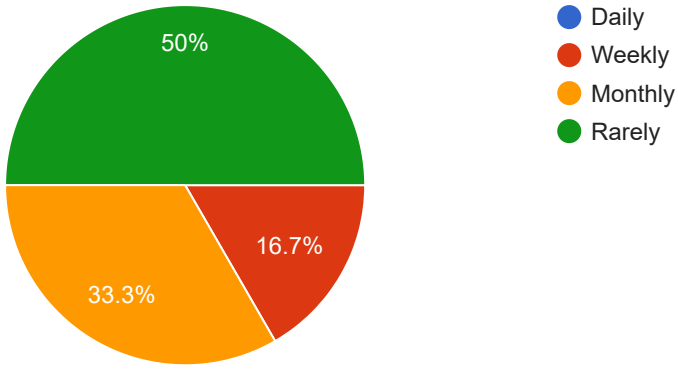
6 responses



Do you follow an established design system at work? (shared components, spacing scales, and design rules)

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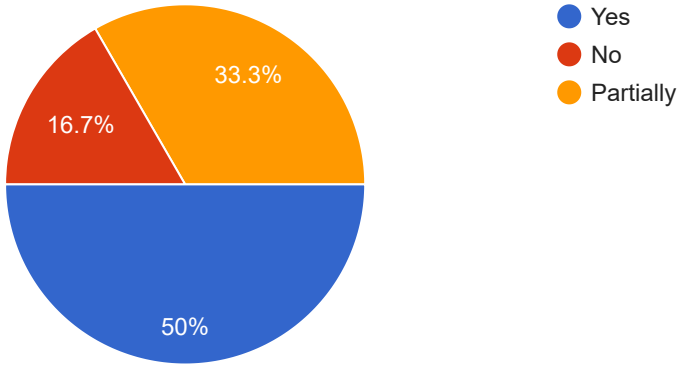
6 responses



Frontend Workflow & Development Process

Describe your typical workflow from initial design to deployed UI

5 responses

Wireframes, Figma, Creating Website, Testing, Deployment

low fidelity wireframes > low fidelity coded project > high fidelity design > high fidelity project > deploy

For small features a general concept is envisioned by text description, and is then implemented, matching existing styling. A stakeholder is then consulted for input on the result before tweaks and finalisation.

For larger features, we generally have the UI prototyped via a UX designer in Adobe XD, before being split up into components and the implementation done. Each component of the design is generally added into Storybook, which helps consistency, and allows us to show stakeholders prior to the functionality being added into the main application.

Try to follow predefined ui, such as teachers' code

complete feature analysis, determine what data is being populating, and what procedure populates them -> develop wireframes that utilise the benefits of the updated technology -> get wireframes approved from client -> create components and unit tests within IDE and push to GitLab repository -> GitLab deploys UI once merged and criteria is met -> review sessions are complete

At what stage do you usually start writing code?

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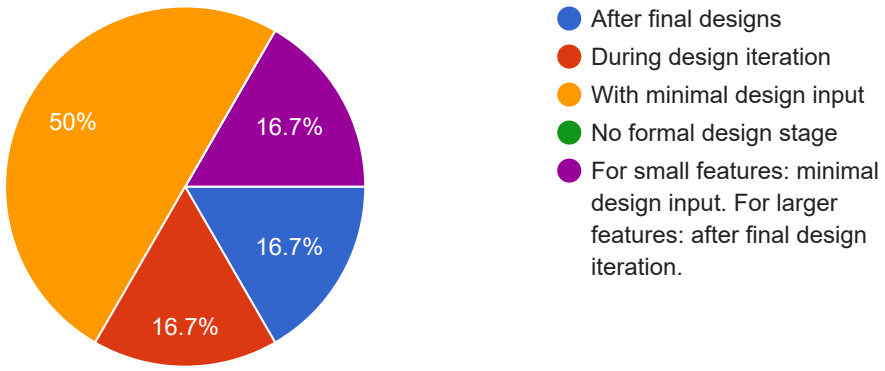
6 responses



How often do designs change after development has started?

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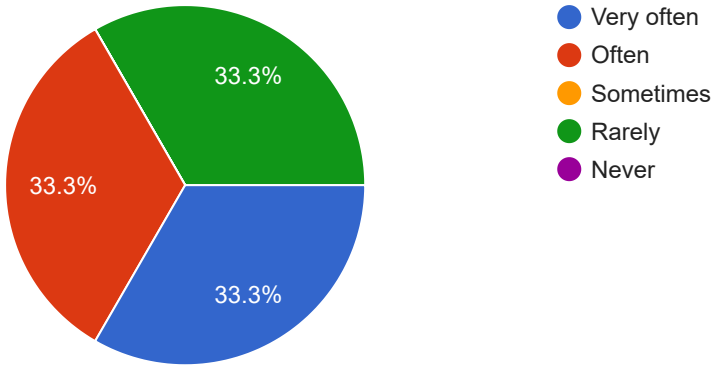

What slows down your UI implementation the most?

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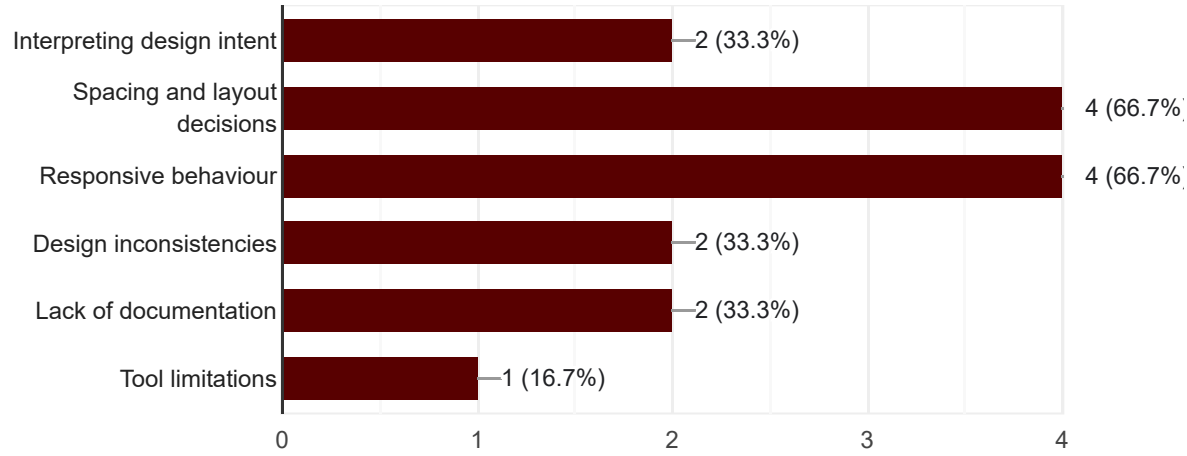

How do you validate UI accuracy against designs?

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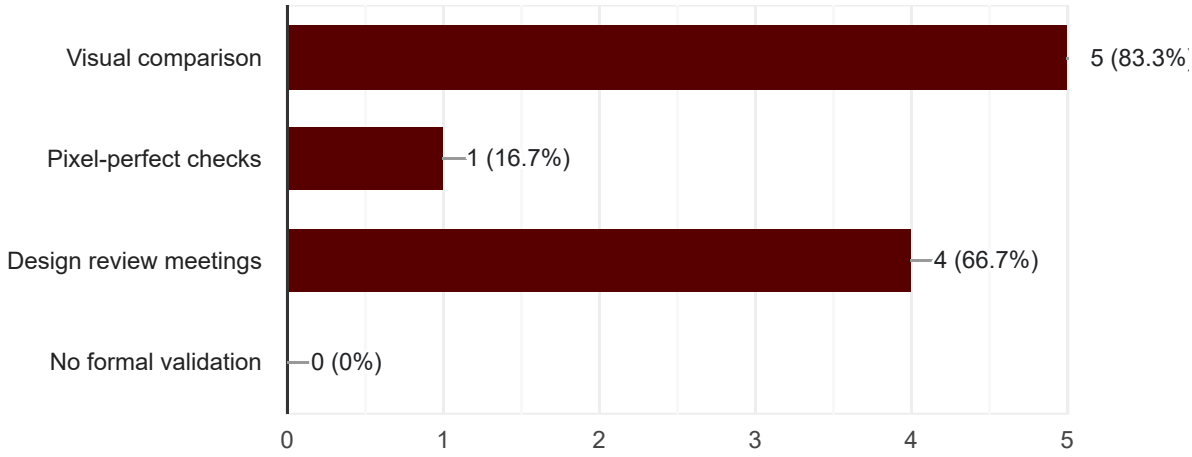

Design Tools & Prototyping

Which design tools do you interact with?

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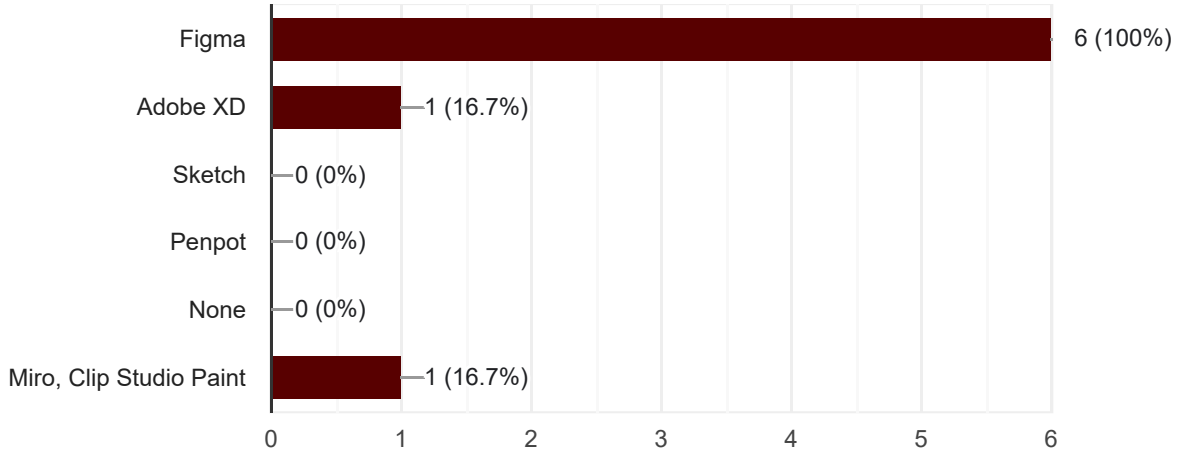

What do you mainly use designs for?

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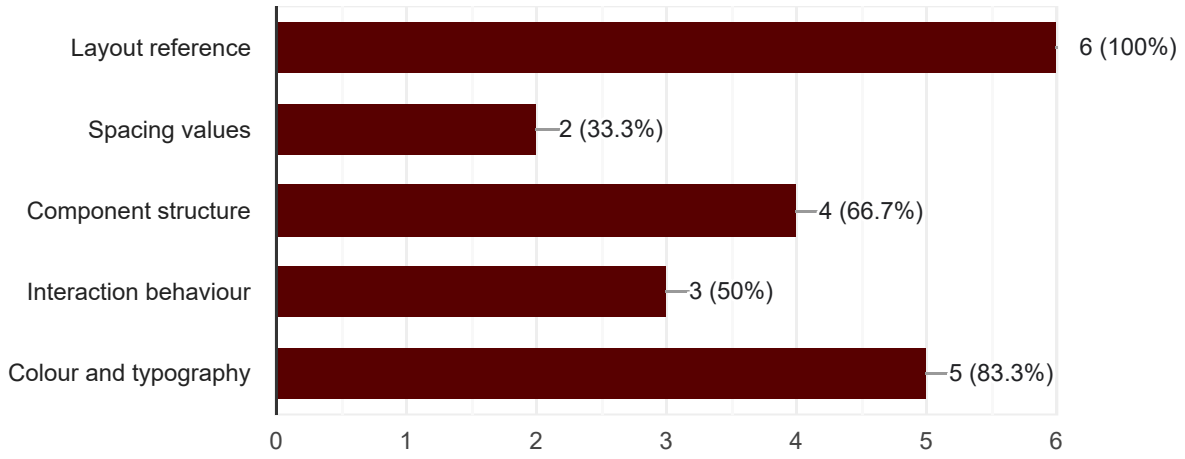

How often do you use prototypes or wireframes

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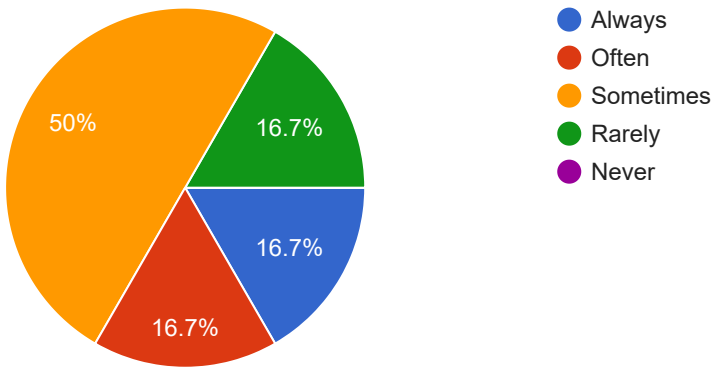

Do prototypes accurately reflect real code implementations?

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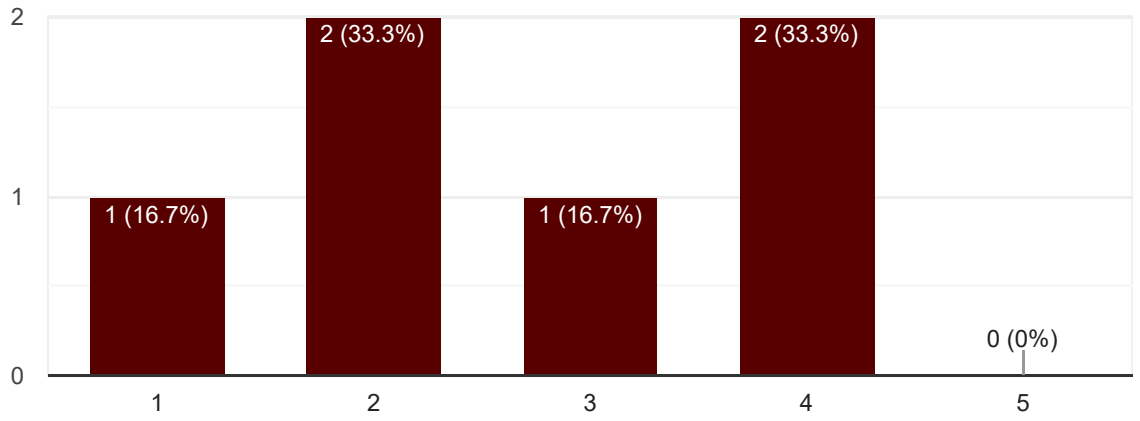

What is commonly missing from wireframes or prototypes?

3 responses

Scale, generally wireframe or prototypes never draw every single thing you need

Fine details, accessibility options, consideration of implementation details.

functionality, our wireframes although they have basic flows between screens that's the only thing that is conveyed on Figma

Figma Deep Dive

How frequently do you use Figma?

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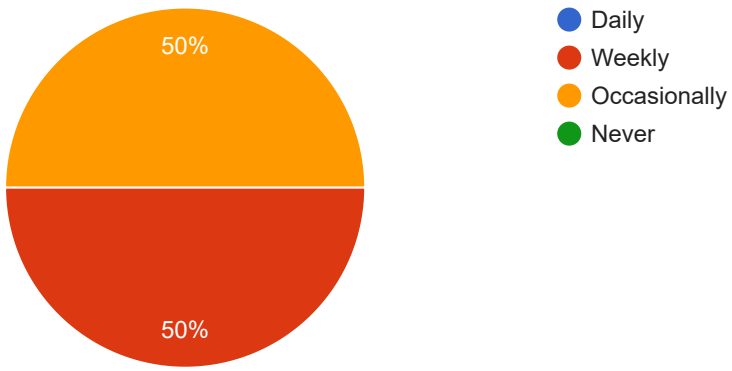

Which Figma features do you rely on most?

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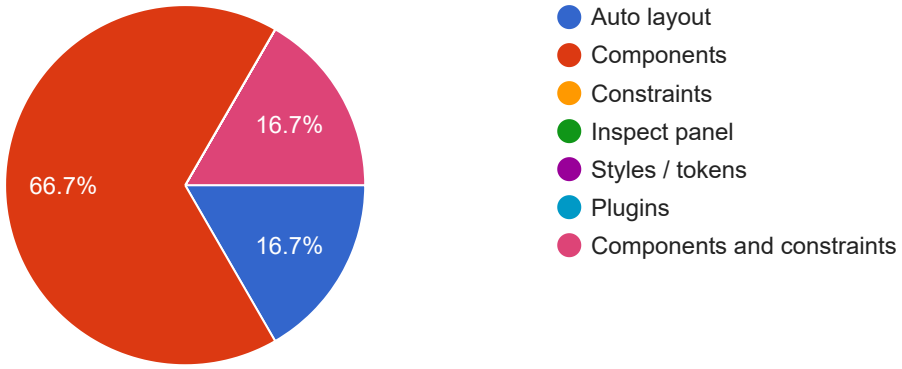

What Figma features cause the most confusion during implementation?

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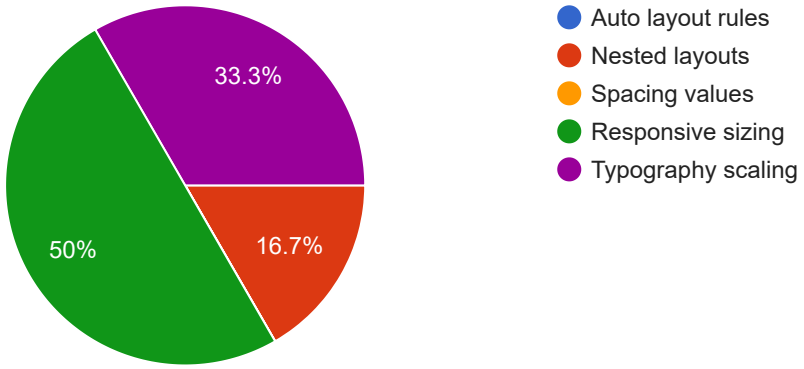

How consistent is Figma's inspect panel values when implementing designs in code?

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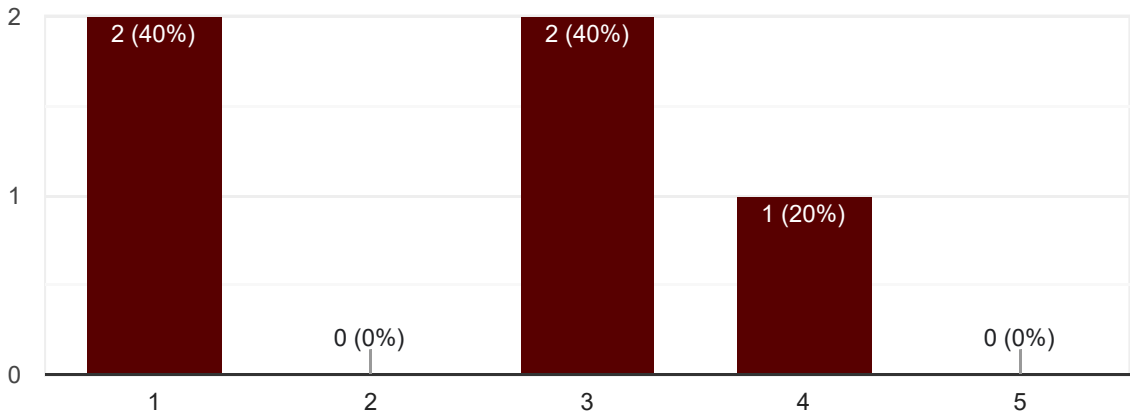
5 responses



Tailwind CSS & Styling Practices

What styling framework approach do you prefer?

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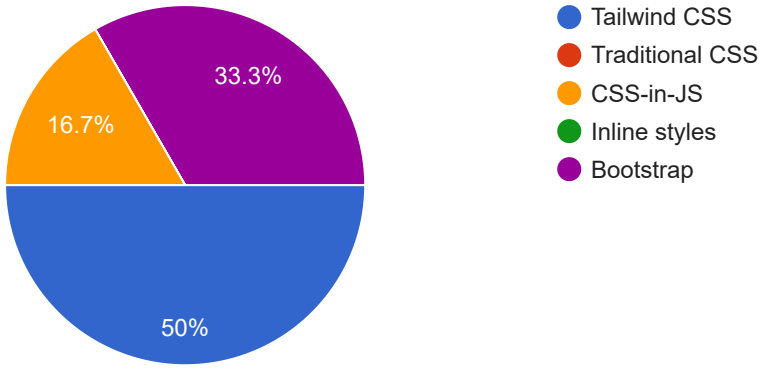
6 responses



Why do you use or avoid Tailwind CSS

5 responses

I find it can become messy or overcomplicated

Tailwind is great for getting something working quickly, and exploring design with code

I use tailwind.
Pros:
- See immediately how a component is styled
- Very easy to see what a classname does, and very easy to add/change styles
- Compiles into small packages

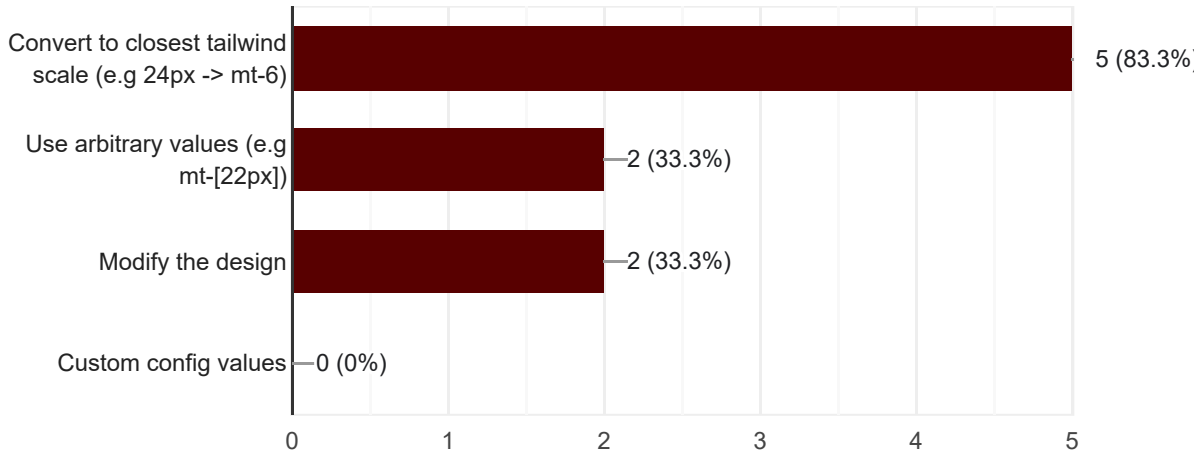
Confusing

Not our company standard

How do you handle non-standard spacing values from designs

Copy

6 responses



What are the biggest drawbacks of utility-first CSS? in your opinion

3 responses

Too much to keep track off

- Lots of boilerplate
- Can be hard to change a particular aspect of the styling across the application if it has not been created with that change in mind
- Sometimes custom classes are required if the utility-first library does not support a certain CSS option

can be hard to make a cohesive name where there could be a lot of different uses

What benefits does Tailwind provide in your workflow?

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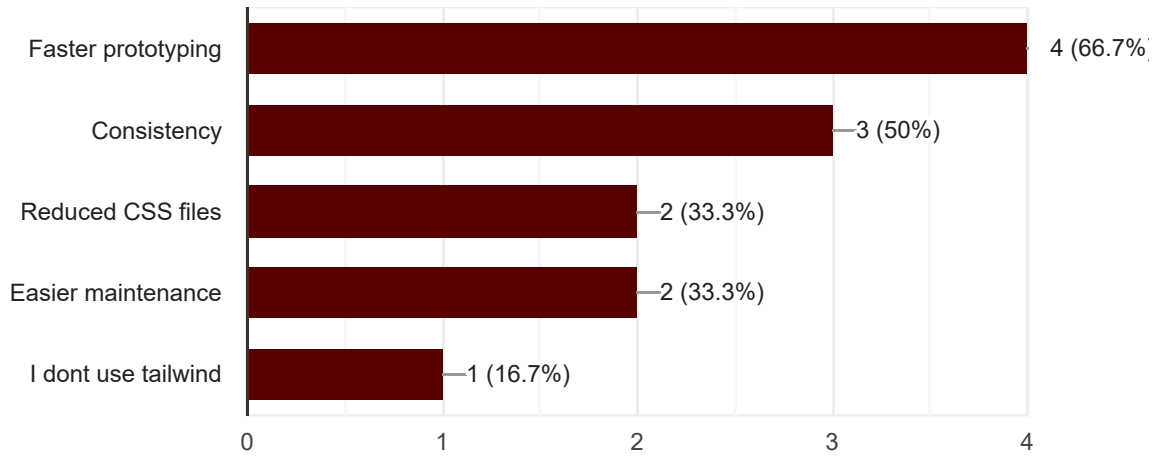
6 responses



Component Building & React

What framework do you mainly build components in?

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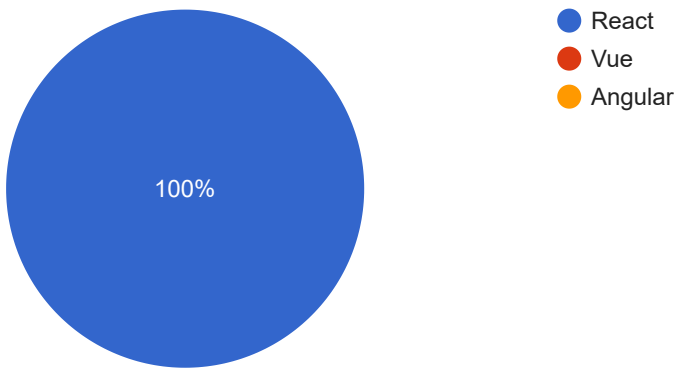
6 responses



How do you structure UI components?

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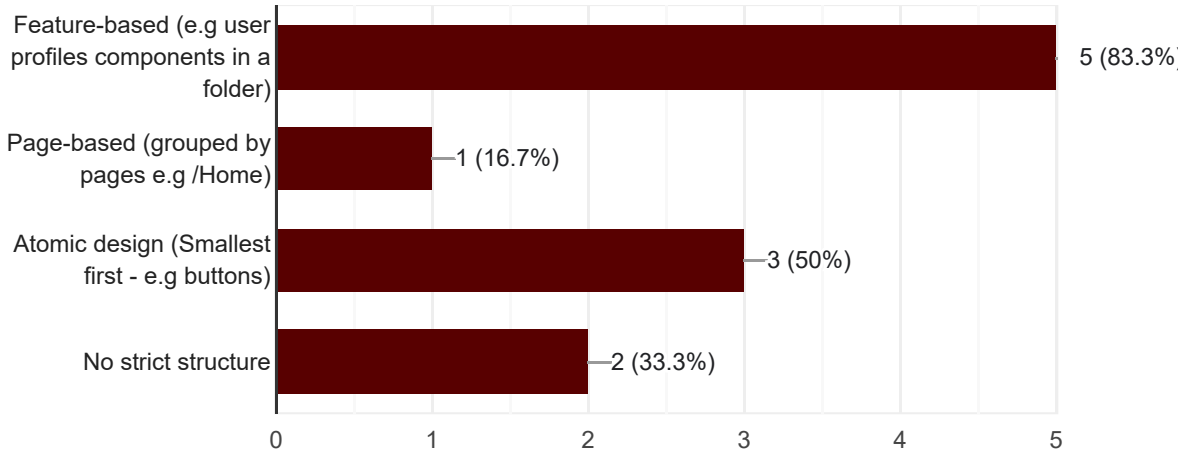
6 responses



How often do you refactor components due to design changes?

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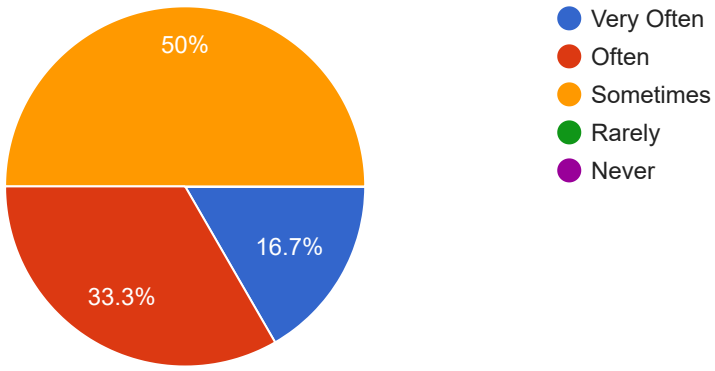
6 responses



What component aspects take the most time to implement?

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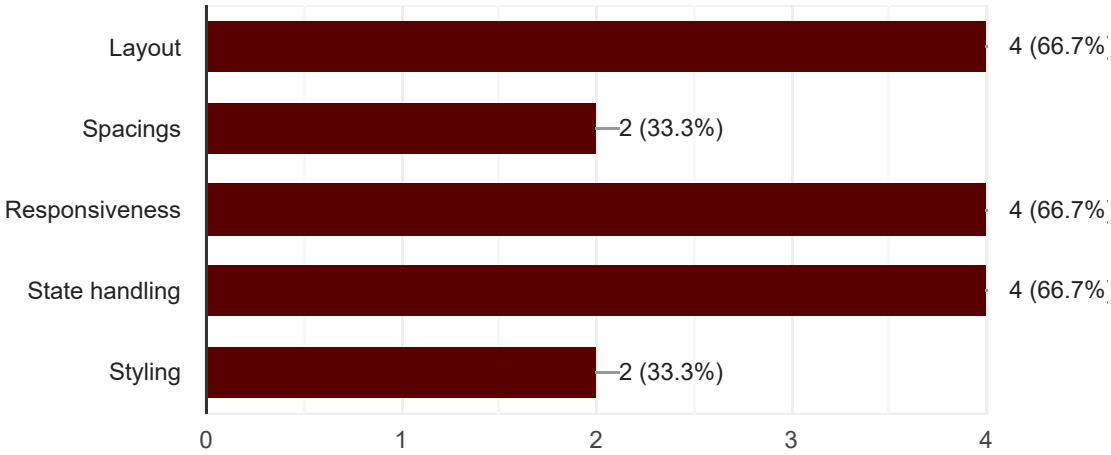

Code Generation & Automation

Have you used design-to-code tools?

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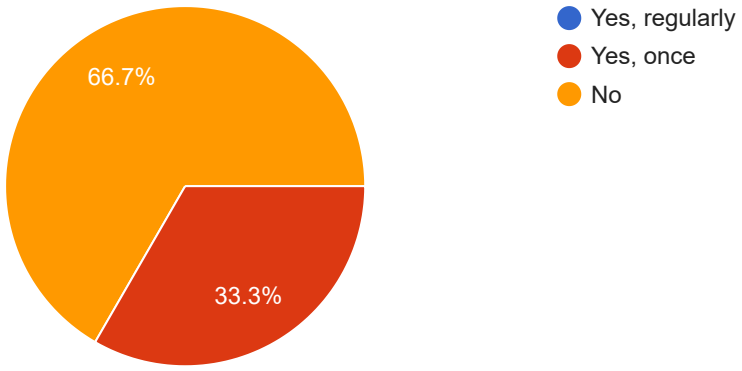
6 responses



What challenges or limitations have you experienced from using code generation tools?

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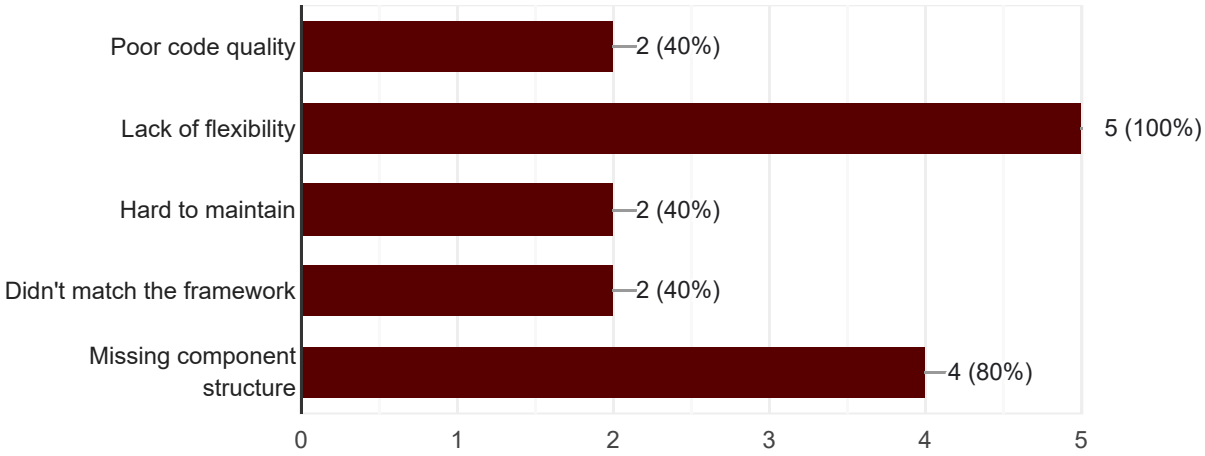
5 responses



What features would make automated code generation usable in your workflow?

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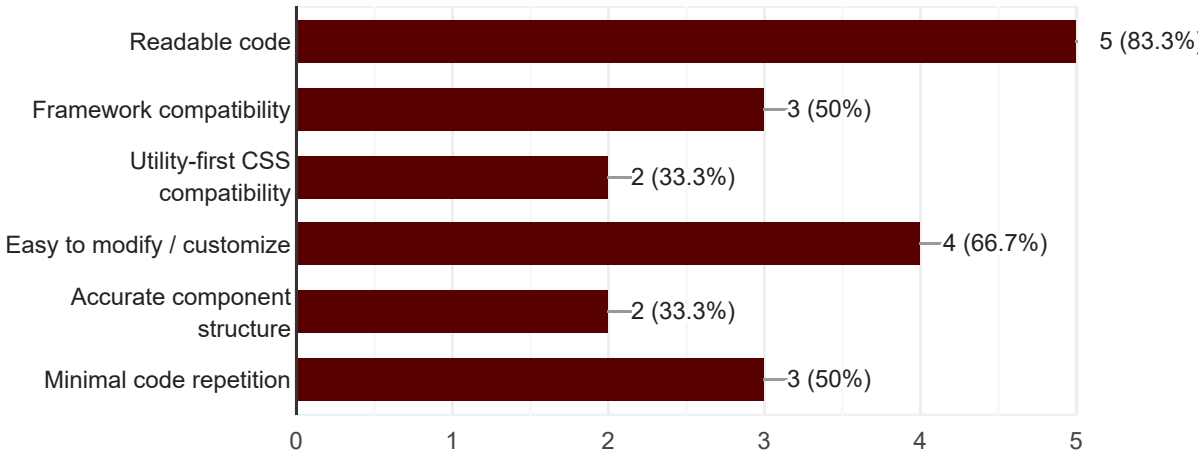
6 responses



Plugin Usage & Expectations

Do you use Figma Plugins in your workflow?

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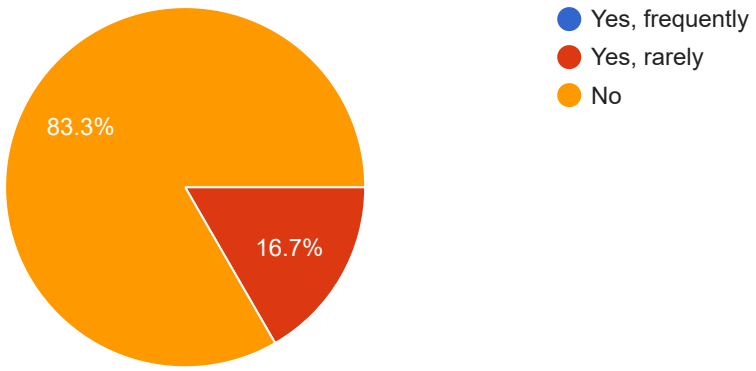
6 responses



What tasks do plugins help you with?

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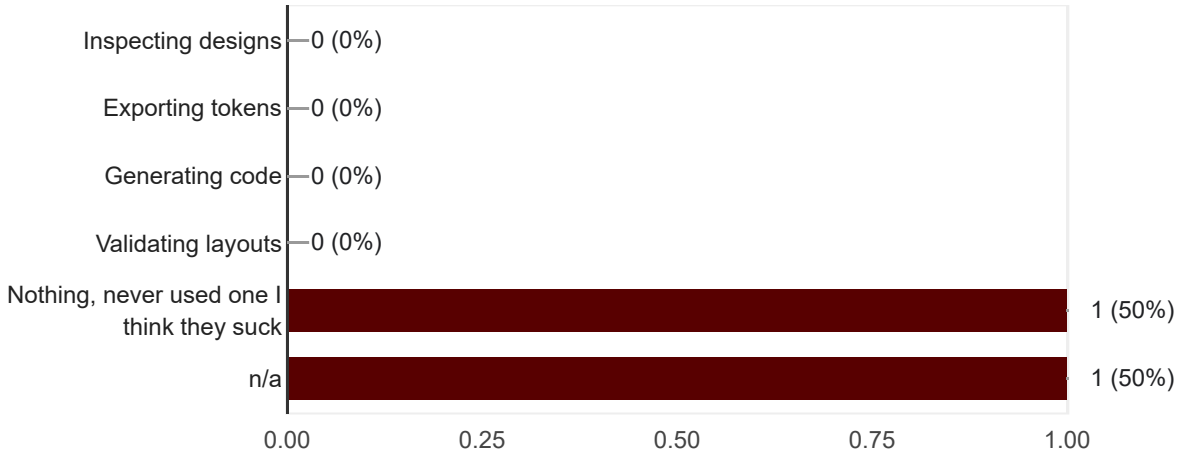
2 responses



What limitations have you encountered with plugins?

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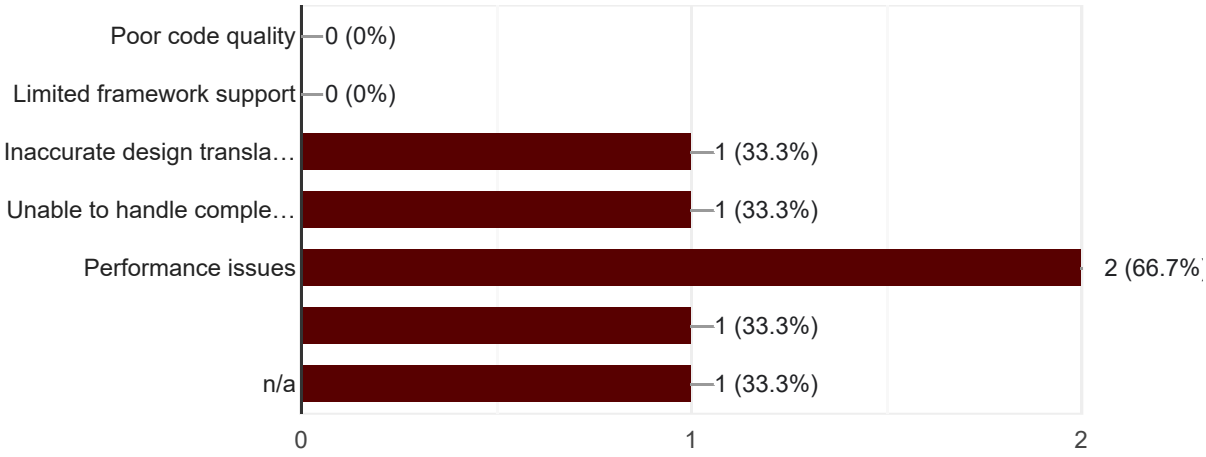
3 responses



What features would an ideal design-to-code plugin have

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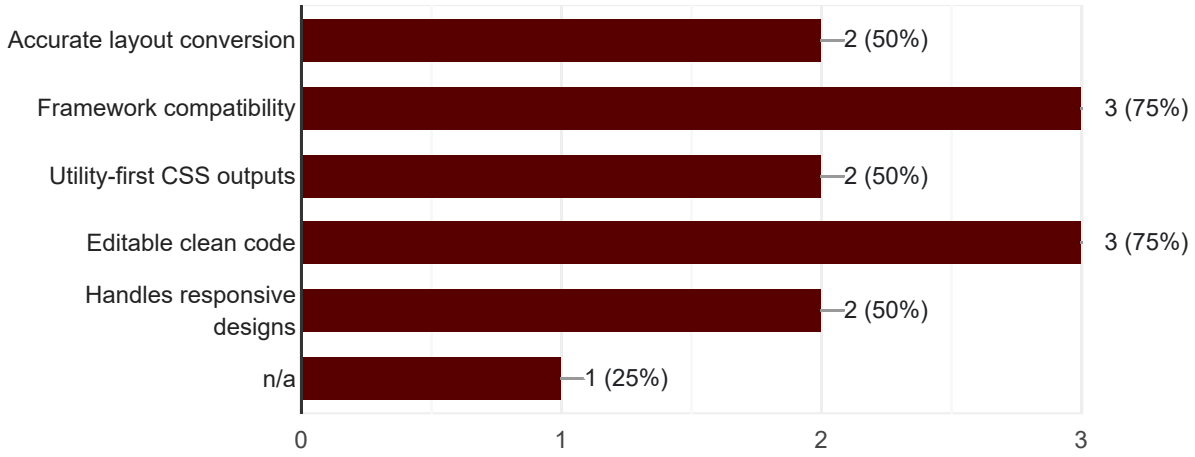
4 responses



Project Validation & Relevance

How often do you manually convert design or inline CSS values to Tailwind classes?

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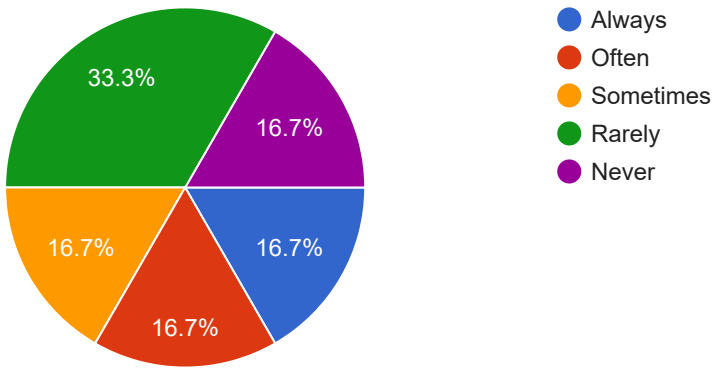
6 responses



Would an automated conversion tool improve your workflow?

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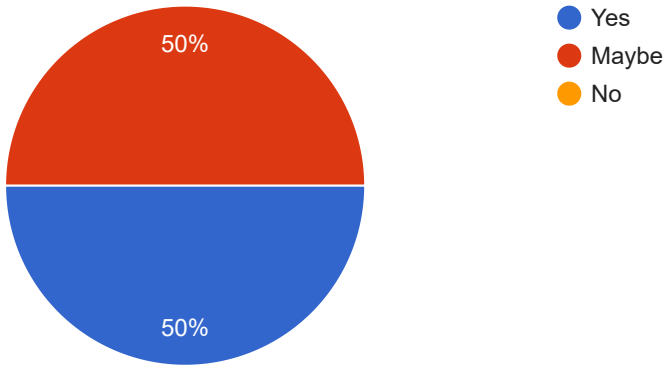
6 responses



What problems would such a tool solve for you?

4 responses

Speed up the design process

Consulting documentation

It wouldn't necessarily solve a problem, but it would certainly be a time-saver for refactoring things to use tailwind, or to quickly prototype a design into the main application.

saves hours of looking into which class does what and which best suits what the page currently looks like

At which stage of your workflow would this tool be most useful?

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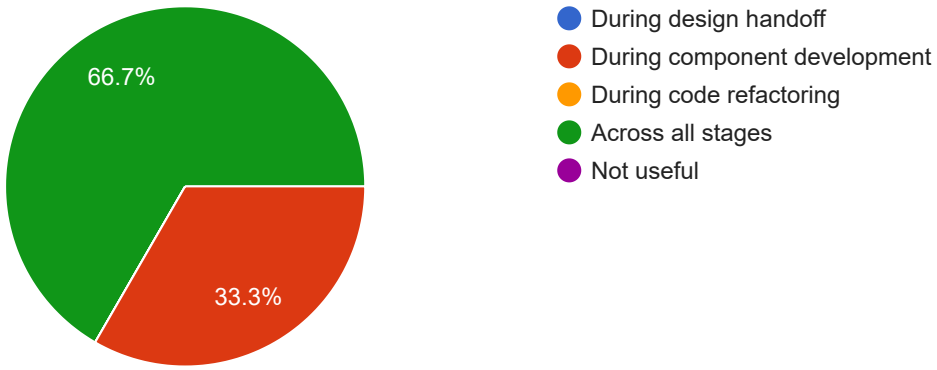
6 responses



Do you believe this tool would benefit teams at scale? Why?

5 responses

Yes, stop inconsitencies between designers and developers and speed everything up overall

Could encourage a consistent pattern/template for the team to follow

Absolutely.

Being able to automate at least part of the design -> code conversion would help us to quickly create prototypes which we could show stakeholders quicker, earlier on in the process. This would mean that we don't need to spend as much time on a specific prototype, so if a stakeholder realises the solution doesn't work as intended, we will not have used too much time in doing so.

Yes, could make implementation easier if everyone understands how to use it

For my situation yes, we take old programs and modify them into more modern solutions, being able to automate changing the inline CSS into frameworks such as Tailwind would help transforming these pages quicker, and shrink the impact of working on spacing, layout and sizing. This allows for webpages to be developed quicker, without the worry of incohesive code, and have code that should be easier to maintain.

Final Reflections

What is the biggest inefficiency in your current UI workflow?

4 responses

Takes too long to organise everything

Tweaking styling to work; fixing flexbox/layout issues.

In my opinion there is no best styling framework because they are all confusing and have non-intuitive implementation

Client uncertainty

What tooling improvements would you like to see in the industry?

2 responses

A more "pipelined" approach - being able to automatically update the code based on changes made in the design application in some intelligent way.

Also, giving the design application context of the codebase in some way so it can write code with more awareness and consistency with the rest of the codebase.

some form of visualisation tool that allows the client to describe what they would like before they bring it to developers to avoid confusion and impossibilities.

Any additional insights related to frontend design, tooling, or automated code generation?

1 response

N/A

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